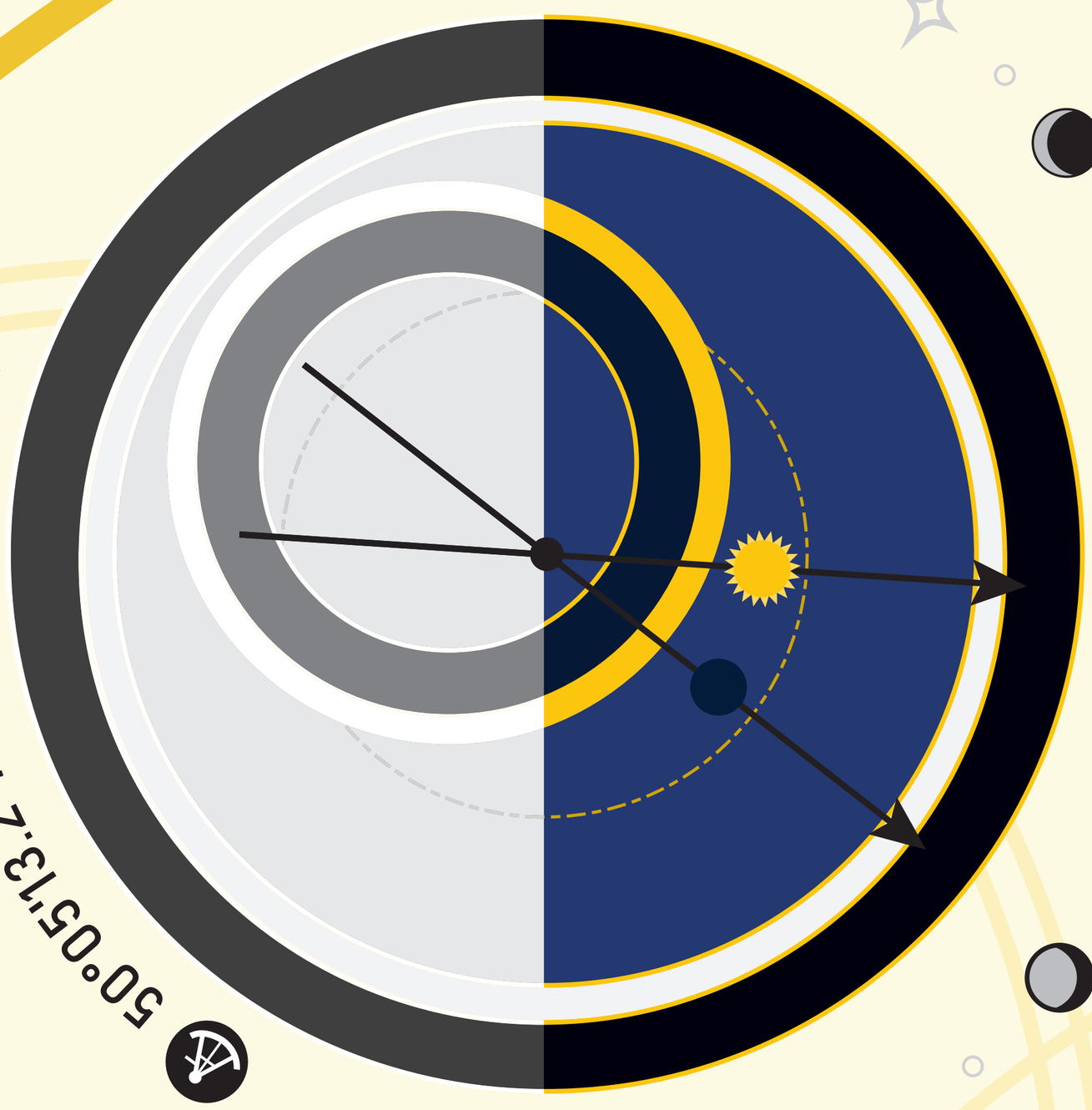
Astronomical Clock

Praha 1, Czechia

Legend

- Ancient Czech Time
- Zodiacs
- 24 Hour Clock
- Equator
- Mean Sun Ecliptic
- Mean Moon Ecliptic



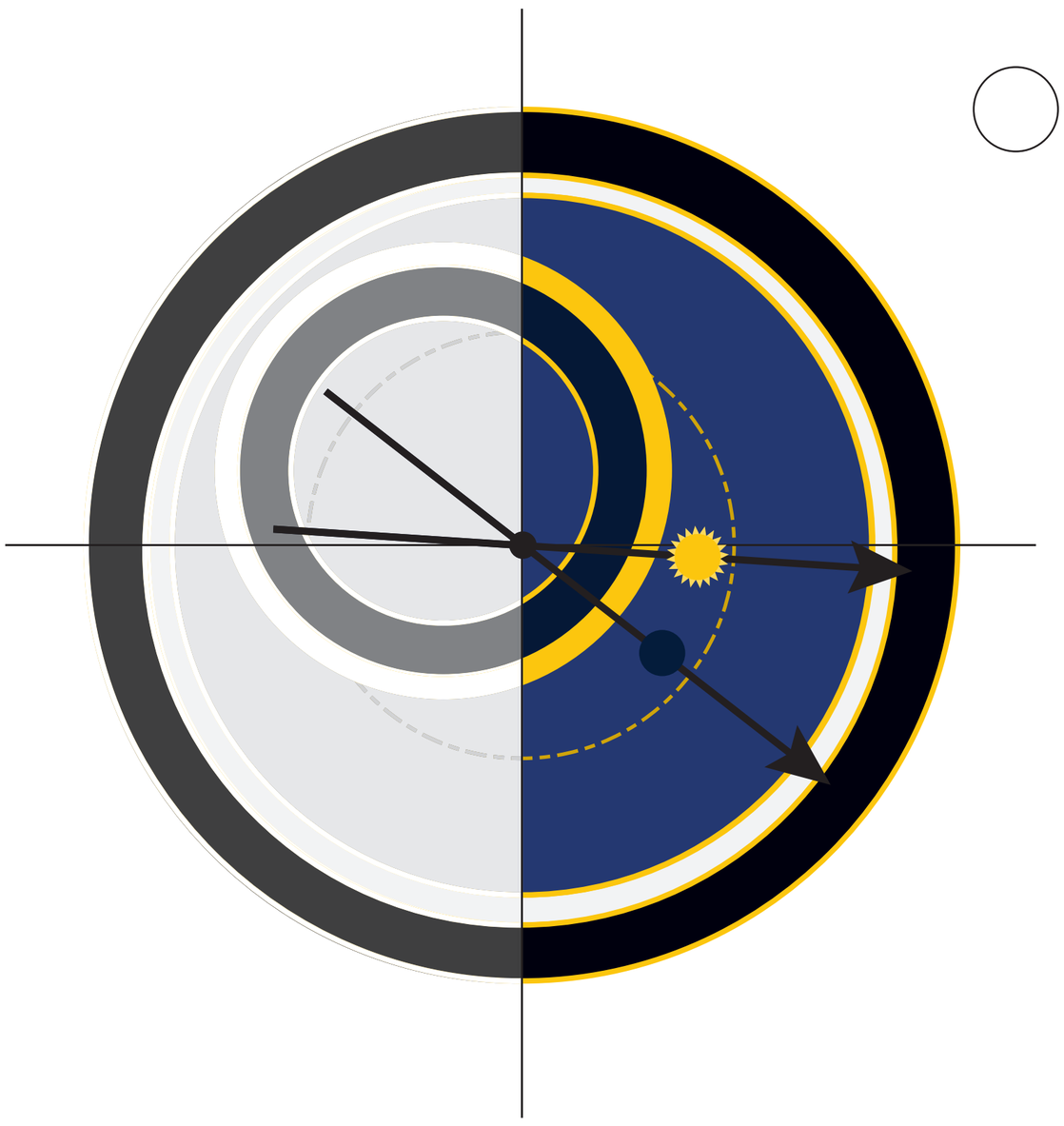
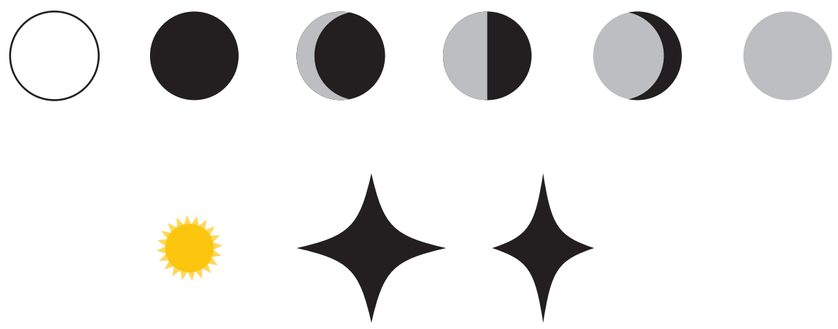
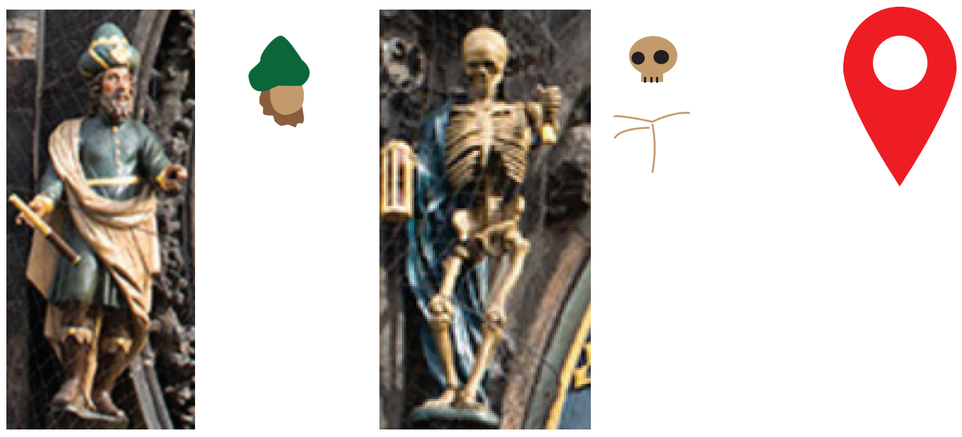
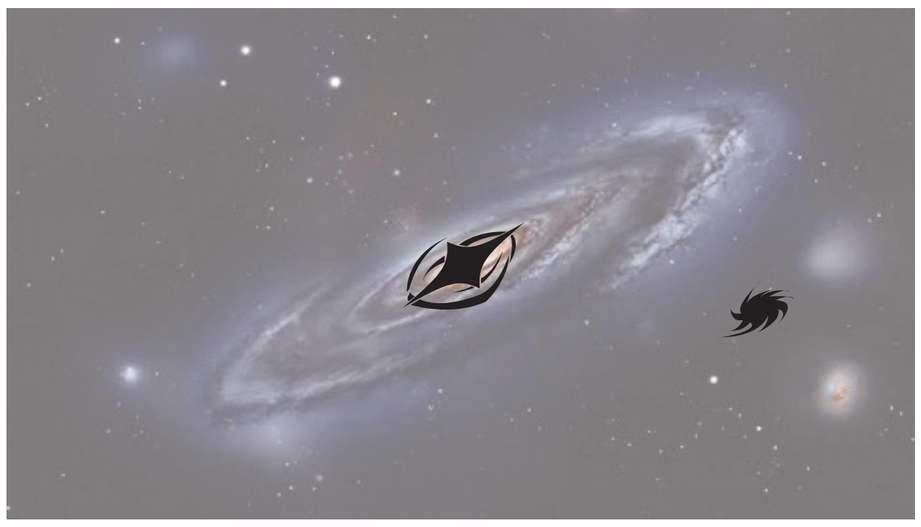
1410
First recorded mention of the clock.

1600s - 1800s
Wooden statues, figures of the Apostles, and the golden rooster were added to the clock.

1945
Sustained heavy damage from armored Nazi vehicle fire; it was repaired in 1948.

2010
Orloj's 600th anniversary!

2018
Most recent renovation of the clock, where the clock mechanism was reverted to the original one from the 1860s.

Eight wooden figures flank the clock: Vanity, Greed, Death, the Turk, the Philosopher, Archangel Michael, the Astronomer, and the Chronicler. When Death rings his bell every hour, the figures shake their heads to signify their unreadiness to die. In present day, these are reconstructions of the originals, which were destroyed in 1945.

Legend has it that if the astronomical clock stops running for an extended period of time, the Czech nation would suffer hardships until it was fixed. The only way to break the curse was for a baby boy to be born on New Year's night.